Q. Who is the No. 1 heroine in the country?



2 KATRINA KAIF
9%
[7%]



3 ALIA BHATT
9%
[-]



4 PRIYANKA CHOPRA
8%
[6%]



5 KANGANA RANAUT
7%
[5%]



1 DEEPIKA PADUKONE
21%
[7%]

Q. Who is the No. 1 OTT star (male) in the country?



1 MANOJ BAJPAYEE
21%
[10%]



2 PANKAJ TRIPATHI
13%
[2%]



3 SAIF ALI KHAN
11%
[5%]



4 NAWAZUDDIN SIDDIQUI
10%
[4%]



5 ABHISHEK BACHCHAN
10%
[13%]

Q. Who is the No. 1 OTT star (female) in the country?



1 SUSHMITA SEN
22%
[13%]



2 RADHIKA APTE
14%
[3%]



3 RAVEENA TANDON
13%
[16%]



4 HUMA QURESHI
9%
[2%]



5 SHEFALI SHAH
7%
[-]

Rest others; Aug. 2022 figures in bold; Jan. 2022 figures in brackets; - No data

with actor Ranbir Kapoor.

The favourites in MOTN's OTT section highlight how audiences have become more appreciative of actors who may not have millions of followers on social media or a big PR machinery promoting their airport or gym looks but do have a body of work that draws admiration. Manoj Bajpayee and Pankaj Tripathi emerged as the most beloved, for making Srikant Tiwari (*The Family Man*), and Kaleen Bhaiyaa (*Mirzapur*) and Madhav Mishra (*Criminal Justice*), respectively, household names. Saif Ali Khan and Nawazuddin Siddiqui, the first actors to board the streaming bandwagon back in 2018 with Netflix's *Sacred Games*, appeared in the top five alongside Abhishek Bachchan, who dropped four places.

It's a similar uplifting story on the female front. Topping the list is Sushmita Sen whose acting career has seen a renaissance, courtesy the crime drama *Aarya* (Disney+ Hotstar). Actresses like Radhika Apte (*Forensic*), Huma Qureshi (*Maharani*, *Mithya*) and Shefali Shah (*Delhi Crime*, *Human*) are busier than ever before thanks to a wave of female-driven shows and films that the OTT revolution has spurred. ■

RAJWANT RAWAT